

HELIOS FAIRFAX PARTNERS CORP HFPC.U

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by nola18

			2026	2027
Price:	1.70	EPS	0	0
Shares Out. (in M):	108	P/E	0	0
Market Cap (in \$M):	184	P/FCF	0	0
Net Debt (in \$M):	0	EBIT	0	0
TEV (in \$M):	0	TEV/EBIT	0	0

Description

OVERVIEW

Helios Fairfax Partners is a publicly-listed permanent capital vehicle that owns a 50% interest in the general partner of Helios Investment Partners — the largest pan-African private equity firm, with approximately \$3 billion in AUM led by founders Tope Lawani and Babatunde Soyoye (both formerly senior at TPG). The entity's balance sheet is composed of four distinct pools of capital: approximately \$150 million invested alongside LPs in Helios Investors Fund IV (Helios's flagship pan-African private equity fund, currently at 2.1x cost and a 23% IRR); approximately \$125 million in Helios Sports and Entertainment, anchored by stakes in NBA Africa, PFL Africa, and other African sports and media assets; approximately \$50 million in Helios Digital Ventures, an early-stage growth strategy targeting African fintech, AI, and blockchain businesses; and approximately \$50 million in cash and liquid securities. The backdrop of strong performance in Helios Fund IV, coinciding with strong African equity market performance, has created a materially improved fundraising environment for Helios Investment Partners. At present, the group is capitalizing on this by raising a \$750 million flagship Fund V and a \$200 million climate infrastructure fund. Over the coming years, Helios's strategic priorities are clear: first, to compound balance sheet value at high rates by sourcing the best opportunities across Africa; and second, to follow the playbook of its US alternative-asset counterparts by growing Helios's AUM through horizontal expansion of strategy offerings beyond traditional private equity.

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Helios Fairfax Partners was originally founded as Fairfax Africa Holdings in 2016 as a publicly listed subsidiary of Fairfax Holdings. While Prem Watsa and the Fairfax team had prior success with their permanent capital vehicle analogue -Fairfax India Holdings - the experience with Fairfax Africa was very much the opposite. An investment team with substantively no Africa investment experience was appointed, and between 2016-2020 the investments made declined in value by almost 50%. And the actual results were far worse than this, as time would show during the clean-up that those investments were in reality worth closer to zero than fifty cents on the dollar. In 2020, the incumbent team at Fairfax Africa was fired, and the holding company merged with Helios Investment Partners as a way to find a way out of the mess. Today, Fairfax owns ~35% of the company, the founders of Helios own ~45%, with only 20% being free float.

(I) NAV VALUE

@ \$1.70 USD per share today, the entirety of HFPC trades at about \$185m. Against a \$185m valuation, you are currently getting \$367m in NAV which is split between:

- \$102m invested alongside LPs in Helios Fund IV (HFPC does not pay fees)
- \$51m in co-investments in Fund IV deals
- \$126m invested in Helios Sports and Entertainment Group
- \$43m invested in Helios Digital Ventures
- \$34m invested in Helios Seven Rivers (publicly listed investment portfolio)
- \$10m in cash

Helios Fund IV - \$102m:

Helios Fairfax Partners has \$102m invested alongside LPs in its Flagship Fund IV, which consists of the 7 companies below. This is a \$360m 2020 vintage fund, which is effectively fully called. Currently marked at a 2.1x on strong underlying portco performance

TTMFS Singapore (Thunes):

Thunes is a leading B2B cross-border payments network. Thunes provides the actual underlying infrastructure - via a single API - that corporates, banks, fintechs, and remittance companies use to make disbursements all around the world to any number of end destinations (i.e., mobile wallets, bank accounts, stable coin wallet, etc.). Western Union, Paypal, Uber Eats, Remitly, Revolut are all Thunes customers. Currently on a run rate of over \$25bn USD annual volume

Helios invested in Thunes in September 2020

Bessemer Venture Partners, Visa, and Insight Partners invested in the \$72m Series C round in 2023. Company held a \$150m Series D round in April 2025 led by Apis Partners and Vitruvian Partners at "a substantial valuation increase".

<https://www.thunes.com/>

Africa Specialty Risks:

Africa Specialty Risks is a pan-African reinsurance provider that Helios Investment Partners founded de novo in September 2020. Launched in partnership with Mikir Shah, former CEO of AXA Africa Specialty Risks, and Bryan Howett, former CEO of Old Mutual's pan-African reinsurance operations. Africa has a perennial lack of insurance capacity, so the opportunities for those that can bring both capital and underwriting skill to table here are immense. ASR has gone from zero in 2020, to \$140m USD of written gross premiums in 2023, to hitting \$500m USD of written gross premiums earlier last year.

** On June 2nd, it was announced that Vitruvian Partners was buying out Helios' majority stake in Africa Specialty Risks. While we don't know the sale price, we know that ASR was ~25% of Fund IV, or about \$160m at the latest mark (\$23m for HFPC look through ownership), which should provide a nice realization. And given the rising value of the platform over the years, I'd expect this was sold at a fair write up to the last mark

<https://www.asr-re.com/>

BIM Morocco

BIM Morocco is the Moroccan subsidiary of the Turkish hard-discount retail giant BIM. BIM is effectively modeled after ALDI, a supermarket with everyday low prices and a large private label offering. Business has been extremely successful and now has 13,000 locations globally, mostly in Turkey. In September 2021, Helios Investment Partners bought 35% of the Moroccan subsidiary from BIM. When they did the deal BIM had 550 stores in Morocco and they were already the largest. Today, they are up to 927 stores and are continuing to grow rapidly (2-3 year payback rate on new stores). BIM is a public company and still reports figures, so we can back into BIM Morocco generating about \$60m USD of EBITDA today vs ~\$40m USD of EBITDA in 2024 and vs Helios's original investment at a \$200m USD valuation.

<https://english.bim.com.tr/Categories/673/investor-presentations.aspx>

T2S Group:

T2S Group is the largest MedTech distributor in Morocco and the 29 French-speaking African countries. The business distributes state-of-the-art medical equipment from the largest manufacturers - GE, Bayer, Braun, Zeiss, etc. - to public and private healthcare facilities across Africa. Helios invested in T2S Group in December 2021, and we can see from HFP disclosures that T2S has been growing EBITDA at a ~15% CAGR in USD - which has inflected higher this year - and that the going-in valuation was ~9x EV/EBITDA.

** On July 6th, T2S Group filed for IPO on the Casablanca Stock Exchange. T2S was roughly 20% of Fund IV, or about \$120m of NAV at last mark. The IPO, which is set to being trading on July 27th will a 1.9x uplift on the T2S mark. Helios Fund IV will receive \$63m in cash from secondary shares sold, and their retained shares will be worth \$170m at the IPO price. Again, a nice result for Fund IV

*** When combined with HFPC's co-investment into T2S Group detailed below... the cash proceeds plus retained value from HFPC's look through exposure to T2S alone is \$98m, or half of the entire HFPC \$185m market cap today

<https://t2s.group/>

IXAfrica:

IXAfrica is a leading developer and operator of hyperscale datacenters in Kenya. The company is East Africa's first and largest hyperscale, carrier-neutral, AI data center. IXAfrica was founded by Guy Willner, who previously founded IXEurope and grew that platform from 1 DC in London in 1998 to 14 DCs across Europe before ultimately being sold to Equinix for \$550m in 2007. Guy has since officially joined the Helios investment team as the head of the new Digital Infrastructure Platform. IXAfrica's first campus is already live with 5MW of capacity, with the remaining 18MW to come online by 2027. In addition, a second campus with 53MW of power capacity is already being planned. Helios invested in IXAfrica in November 2022.

<https://ixafrika.co.ke/>

3MDC

In November 2022, Helios acquired a majority stake in the Maroc Datacenter (MDC), a fast growing carrier-neutral Tier III datacenter in Morocco. In December 2025, Helios announced that it would be merging MDC with Munisys and Medasys (the original parent company of the Maroc Datacenter), to create 3MDC which would be 44% owned by Helios. This platform would

bring together two leading IT Systems Integrators with owned high-quality infrastructure, to serve Moroccan enterprise and public sector clients with a fully integrated hybrid-cloud platform.

<https://www.mdc.ma/about-us/>

M2P Solutions

M2P is one of the largest Banking-as-a-Service (BaaS) providers. The group has a broad product suite that enables financial institutions, fintechs, and non-bank companies to seamlessly deploy scalable modern solutions across loan origination, collections, payments, KYC, and other core banking activities. The group serves 200+ banks, 300+ lenders, and 800+ fintechs. M2P was founded in India, which accounts for roughly half of its revenue, however Africa is the company's fastest growing international market.

In September 2024, Helios Investment Partners led a \$100m Series D to help accelerate M2P's growth across the African continent. M2P is expected to hit \$100m in ARR by the end of 2025, has been growing at a 40% CAGR, and Helios made its investment at an \$800m valuation.

Other notable investors in M2P include Insight Partners and Tiger Global.

<https://m2pfintech.com/>

Helios Fund IV Co-Investments - \$51m

Helios Fairfax Partners has made 2 co-investment alongside its Fund IV investments directly on the HFP balance sheet. These are

\$34m in T2S Group

\$16.1m in M2P Solutions

M2P Solutions is currently marked at cost

*** see the T2S Group commentary above

Helios Sports and Entertainment Group - \$126m

Helios is building the largest Sports and Entertainment platform in Africa. They are currently in advanced stages of raising an additional \$50m into this platform at an expected \$200m valuation. The platform is currently entirely owned by Helios Fairfax Partners, and consists of the 4 assets below.

NBA Africa

In May 2021, Helios Investment Partners became a founding investor alongside the NBA in the creation of NBA Africa. The NBA has a decades-long history in Africa, focused principally on increasing access to the sport across the continent, in addition to the more recent founding of the Basketball Africa League (BAL) in 2019. The formation of NBA Africa as a standalone entity will help the NBA to accelerate that growth with the help of local expertise, and allows Helios to own a world-class entertainment and media asset within a continent of 1.5 billion people with the largest youth population globally. Since inception, BAL has operated on an open qualification tournament format where newly formed teams compete for the chance to play in the regular season each year. However, the next step in the evolution which is happening currently is to establish 12 newly created local franchises backed by outside investors. Initial interest in owning one of these franchises has been very high. Currently game viewership for NBA Africa is growing at a 50% CAGR.

Helios Investment Partners owns an approximate 5% stake in NBA Africa

<https://africa.nba.com/>

The Malachite Group (TMG)

TMG is the world's leading live entertainment platform for African music and talent. The group's portfolio includes more than 20 internationally recognised and award-winning properties, such as Afro Nation and Piano People. TMG produces and promotes more than 50 live experiences each year, and it has sold more than 2 million tickets since its inception 7 years ago.

Helios Investment Partners invested in TMG in June 2022, and today owns approximately 60% of the business.

<https://themalachitegroup.com/>

Zaria Group

Zaria Group is a real estate development platform focused on opportunistic development opportunities surrounding existing, or newly planned sports and entertainment hubs. The company is a joint venture between Helios Investment Partners, and former Toronto Raptors NBA star Masai Ujiri. The group's first development, Zaria Court Kigali, is a \$26m development located adjacent to Kigali's BK Arena and Amahoro Stadium. The development features an 80 room boutique hotel, integrated retail and F&B, as well as a 2,000 person event space.

Helios invested in Zaria Group in 2023, and owns 25% of the platform.

<https://www.zariacourt.com/>

PFL Africa

PFL Africa is the regional subsidiary of the Professional Fighters League. PFL is the fastest growing sports league worldwide, and its MMA events are broadcast and streamed worldwide to over 170 countries and 700 million fans. PFL is backed by major blue-chip investors including SURJ, Ares, 885 Capital, Knighthood, Luxor Capital, Waverley Capital, Elysian Park Ventures, and numerous NBA, MLB, NHL, and MLS team owners.

In 2024, Helios invested \$15m for a 25% ownership stake in PFL Africa.

<https://pflmma.com/about>

Helios Digital Ventures - \$43m

In 2022, Helios Investment Partners launched Helios Digital Ventures, their new VC strategy which would target earlier stage companies than their flagship PE fund. This platform is currently entirely owned by Helios Fairfax Partners and consists of \$43m invested across the 6 companies below.

Paymob

Paymob is a leading merchant acquirer in Egypt, The group offers payment gateway solutions for ecommerce transactions, POS solutions for offline transactions, as well as a suite of products to help SMBs better manage their business. Paymob was founded in 2015, and today manages payments for 350k+ merchants, a figure which has tripled since 2022.

Helios Investment Partners invested in the \$72m series B round in May 2022 alongside Paypal Ventures.

<https://paymob.com/en/>

Nomba

Nomba is a leading African Neobank that was founded in Lagos, Nigeria in 2016. The group has a comprehensive offering for both personal and business use, including multicurrency mobile wallets, instant payment transfers, simplified cash savings products, and a range of business offerings for SMB clients. Nomba is currently on a run rate of more than \$20bn in transactions annually

Helios invested in Nomba's Series B round in May 2023 alongside Khosla Ventures, Base10 Partners (investors in Nubank, Plaid and Brex), and Shopify

<https://nomba.com/>

Conduit

Conduit is a modern financial infrastructure company that specializes in cross-border B2B payments by bridging traditional fiat banking with stablecoin technology. The group empowers companies to seamlessly transact in and out of stablecoins and local fiat currencies, between a wide range of networks and domestic payment rails, with deep connectivity across Latin America, Africa, and Asia. In the last year, transaction volume on Conduit has grown 16x to reach \$10 billion annualized.

Helios Investment Partners invested in Conduit's seed round in August 2024. In May 2025, Conduit raised a \$36m Series A, which Helios also participated in, which was included Altos Ventures, Dragonfly, and Circle Ventures.

<https://conduitpay.com/>

Moment

Moment is a pan-African payments platform launched as a joint venture between the entertainment giant MultiChoice Group, global fintech Rapyd, and venture capital firm General Catalyst. Since its official launch in 2023, Moment has rapidly scaled to support third-party merchants, offering advanced features like real-time payments, virtual multicurrency accounts, and specialized tools for SMBs.

Helios Investment Partners invested in Moment's Series B in July 2025.

<https://momentco.net/>

Galatea Bio

Galatea Bio is a next-generation sequencing molecular diagnostics clinical laboratory and biobank. The company is focused on rectifying the diversity gap in genomics by building the world's most comprehensive genetic database of underrepresented populations - principally focused on African, Asia, and Latin American diaspora. By leveraging multi-omics, AI, and real-world data, Galatea Bio aims to unlock new drug targets for cardiometabolic diseases, cancer, neurodegenerative disorders, and more.

Helios Investment Partners led the \$25m seed round in Galatea Bio in March 2025. Other notable investors include Founder Collective and F-Prime.

<https://galatea.bio/>

SeamlessHR

SeamlessHR is Africa's leading HR software company. The platform is an all-in-one HR software for workforce management, recruitment, payroll, performance, time management and employee benefits. SeamlessHR is currently growing at >100% CAGR.

Helios invested in SeamlessHR's series A in January 2025.

<https://seamlesshr.com/>

Helios Seven Rivers - \$34m

Helios Seven Rivers is a team that manages Helios's publicly listed investments across Africa. The performance since inception in 2023 has been very good. However, this is more of a liquidity source to make new private investments.

(II) GP VALUE

On top of this large and growing discount to NAV, HFPC owns a 50% ownership in the GP of Helios Investment Partners, which is currently managing \$3 billion of AUM. At present the management fee stream is not generating a excess profits (it is a ~\$15m annual net performance detractor today), although the economics there start to inflect meaningfully as they cross \$4bn in AUM. However, with an entitlement to 50% of the carry on Fund IV and every fund thereafter, the carry potential here against the \$185m market cap is really meaningful. For instance, Fund IV is already at a 2.1x, and they expect that it could end up near a 3.5x-4x fund if continued portco performance holds. If that fund is a 3x, HFPC receives \$60 million in carried interest. If that fund is a 4x, HFPC receives more like \$90m. They also just raised \$200m for a new renewables energy strategy, and \$300m for their Flagship Fund V, where they are targeting \$750m. With some help from the LP community and maybe Africa / Frontier markets one day coming back into favor... I see no reason why Helios couldn't scale to \$20bn+ in AUM, at which point that 50% ownership stake would arguably be worth a few billion dollars. Again, paying nothing for that today

(III) OTHER

In March, Helios formally proposed to buyout the remaining 55% of CAB Payments shareholders at 86p (vs its 335p IPO price). HFPC currently does not have any exposure to CAB, as this was a Helios Fund III investment. However that would change materially if the deal is able to be completed as the proposal is for up to \$75 million directly from the HFPC balance sheet. If that were to occur, I would view this as a big win, as I think the asset and valuation are extremely attractive. However, the board has formally opposed the offer as opportunistic, and StoneX actually bid 110p for the company following Helios' offer. However, the StoneX offer was DOA as Helios said they would not be supporting a competing offer. Unclear what happens from here, but worth keeping an eye on, as it could be material on a go forward basis

I do not hold a position with the issuer such as employment, directorship, or consultancy.
I and/or others I advise hold a material investment in the issuer's securities.

Catalyst

- NAV growth and closing Fund V at target

Messages

No messages